Zulafqar Ali

Principal Software Engineer | Python · FastAPI · LLMs · GCP

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Open to Remote Roles 9+ Years of Experience Nationality: Pakistani
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Software Engineer with **9+ years** of experience building and scaling backend systems, hands-on with **Python, FastAPI and LangChain** and **LLM-powered features** on **GCP**, plus **Vue** on the frontend and **Kibana / Grafana / Hadoop** for observability and data. Delivered microservices platforms serving millions of users, SuiteCRM solutions with AI-assisted screening and job matching, and real-time QuickBooks synchronization for tax and accounting workflows. Strong in requirements analysis, solution design, REST API development, CI/CD, production debugging, code review and mentoring. Has **led teams of 4 to 6 engineers** and collaborated in cross-functional teams of up to 40. Seeking remote Python / FastAPI backend roles.

9+ Years
Backend engineering in PHP

Millions
Users on platforms delivered (80+ branches)

7,000+
CRM users, healthcare recruitment platform

4 – 6
Engineers led per project, on schedule

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Software Engineer
Dec 2022 – Present

Tkxel · Lahore, Pakistan

- Built backend services on a **Laravel microservices architecture on AWS** powering online ordering across 80+ restaurant branches and millions of users — custom item preparation, loyalty programs, kitchen-to-customer order status updates, payment gateway integrations and delivery workflows.
- Set up **AWS CI/CD deployment pipelines** for automated releases; debugged and resolved production issues on the live system.
- Building a **SuiteCRM healthcare recruitment platform** for 7,000+ CRM users with AI-assisted candidate assessments, resume screening, survey generation and profile-to-job matching.
- Defined solution architecture from client requirements and implemented **eDocs**, a document digitization and e-signature application (team of 12).
- Analyzed client requirements and translated them into technical solutions within a **40-engineer cross-functional team**.
- Mentor junior developers, conduct code reviews and enforce coding standards.

Senior Software Engineer
Jan 2022 – Dec 2022

CarSwitch · Lahore, Pakistan

- Translated product-team requirements into technical solutions, breaking down tasks and estimating effort, and delivered application features on time using **PHP and Yii2**.
- Diagnosed and resolved complex design and technical issues; provided technical support for clients across local and global sites.
- Delivered internal tech sessions to the engineering team.

Senior Software Engineer
Jan 2020 – Jan 2022

Rolustech · Lahore, Pakistan

- Customized SuiteCRM into **ttgat.us**, a tax audit and accounting platform covering business audits, invoicing, payments and work-progress tracking for **200+ CRM users**.
- Re-engineered data-processing and accounting-book workflows handling roughly **50 GB of financial data**, and built **real-time, two-way synchronization** with QuickBooks Online.
- Automated manual insurance and device-repair processes in **Xension**, a custom CRM with role-based access and task assignment for hundreds of users, supporting millions of requests.
- Led teams of **4 to 6 engineers and QAs** across multiple projects, running daily scrums and bi-weekly sprints and shipping on schedule.

Software Engineer
Mar 2017 – Dec 2019

Rolustech · Lahore, Pakistan

- Worked with development and QA teams to design and build solutions meeting client requirements for **functionality, scalability and performance**.
- Identified and resolved complex design and technical issues across projects; provided end-user support to clients on local and global sites.

Web Developer
Jul 2014 – Jan 2017

EGlobal Solution · Lahore, Pakistan

- Converted design mockups into working websites using **HTML, JavaScript, AJAX and JSON**.
- Planned and implemented website changes and integrations to streamline client business operations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Stack	Python, FastAPI, Pydantic, AsyncIO, REST APIs, LangChain, LLM APIs (OpenAI, Claude), GCP (Cloud Run, Cloud Functions, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub)
AI-Assisted Dev	GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, JetBrains AI Assistant, ChatGPT Codex, OpenCode, Cursor; Context Writing & Memory Management, Agents & Skill Creation, Prompt Writing & Engineering
Cloud & DevOps	GCP, AWS (Aurora, CI/CD pipelines), Docker, GitLab CI/CD, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket
Frontend	Vue.js, JavaScript, TypeScript, jQuery, AJAX, HTML5, CSS3, AngularJS
Backend (PHP)	PHP, Laravel, Symfony, Yii2, CodeIgniter, Zend; Microservices, OOP, MVC, Design Patterns
Observability & Data	Kibana, Grafana, Hadoop, MySQL, AWS Aurora, Redis, MS SQL, SQLite
CRM & Integrations	SuiteCRM, SugarCRM, QuickBooks Online API & PHP SDK, Payment gateways, Third-party APIs
Practices & Tools	Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, Code Review, Requirements Analysis, Solution Design, Technical Mentoring; Jira, Teamwork, Trello, Redmine, PHPStorm

INDUSTRY DOMAINS

Online Ordering & Food Delivery · Healthcare Recruitment · Tax & Accounting · Document Digitization & E-Signature · Insurance & Device Repair · Automotive Marketplace · CRM Platforms

CERTIFICATIONS

- SugarCRM Developer Certification

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science 2016

The University of Lahore, Pakistan

Open to Remote: Based in Lahore, Pakistan (UTC+5) — available for remote Python and FastAPI backend roles.

LANGUAGES

English — Professional Working Proficiency **Urdu** — Native